

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000). The prevalence of mental health problems in the UK is estimated to be 10% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems in the workplace. The UK Government has published a number of documents in recent years, including the *Mental Health at Work* (Department of Health 1999) and the *Guidelines for Employers* (Mental Health Foundation 2000). These documents provide guidance on how employers can support people with mental health problems in the workplace.

One of the key challenges for employers is to identify and support people with mental health problems in the workplace. This can be difficult because mental health problems are often hidden and can be difficult to diagnose. However, there are a number of signs and symptoms that can indicate a person may have a mental health problem. These include changes in behaviour, mood, and performance.

Employers can take a number of steps to support people with mental health problems in the workplace. These include providing a supportive environment, offering flexible working arrangements, and providing access to mental health services. Employers can also provide training and support to help people with mental health problems manage their condition.

It is important for employers to take a proactive approach to supporting people with mental health problems in the workplace. This can help to reduce the risk of people with mental health problems leaving the workplace and can help to improve their overall well-being. Employers can also benefit from having a supportive workforce, as this can lead to increased productivity and reduced absenteeism.

There are a number of resources available to help employers support people with mental health problems in the workplace. These include the *Mental Health at Work* (Department of Health 1999) and the *Guidelines for Employers* (Mental Health Foundation 2000). Employers can also contact their local mental health services for advice and support.

Supporting people with mental health problems in the workplace is a complex task, but it is one that is worth the effort. By taking a proactive approach, employers can help to create a supportive environment where people with mental health problems can thrive. This can lead to a more productive and resilient workforce, which is a benefit for everyone.

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